

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 190

By Yager

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Sheriff Wayne M. Potter.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the untimely passing of Sheriff Wayne M. Potter; and

WHEREAS, Sheriff Potter was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born in Oak Ridge on January 3, 1975, Wayne Potter grew up in Wartburg, where he graduated from Wartburg Central High School, and he went on to attend Cleveland State University, graduating from the Cleveland State University Law Enforcement Training Academy; and

WHEREAS, he began his law enforcement career at the Brushy Mountain State Penitentiary as a correctional officer in 1995, and in 1998, he joined the Morgan County Sheriff's Office, serving as a correctional officer at the county jail; and

WHEREAS, ever eager for greater challenges, Sheriff Potter rose through the ranks of the office, always securing the respect and admiration of his community and colleagues, and in addition to serving with the Wartburg Police Department and the Oliver Springs Police Department, he worked as a school resource officer, patrolman, and narcotics investigator, displaying his wide range of capabilities and excellence; and

WHEREAS, in 2018, Sheriff Potter began his first term as sheriff of Morgan County after his successful election, and after four years of decreasing crime, improving the office's capacities for ensuring public safety, and further cementing the trust of his constituency, he was reelected in 2022, in an uncontested election—a historic first in Morgan County; and

WHEREAS, his strength in the midst of the many trials of law enforcement always originated in his unshakeable faith, which granted him the peace of a promised rest in eternity; and

WHEREAS, Sheriff Potter was also deeply devoted to his family, spending time traveling with them as often as he could, and he always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, apart from his law enforcement work, Sheriff Potter provided for his family by owning local businesses, including the Wartburg-based Blue Line Security, and through property investment management; and

WHEREAS, he is survived by his loving wife, Lea Potter; his children, Jesse Garcia, Mary (Brandon) McCoy, Wendy Marie Potter (Hayden) Freels, Wayna Malea Potter, Wayla Makaela Potter, and Wayne Potter, Jr.; his granddaughters, Adrianna Jessalynn Garcia and Amaia Skye McCoy; and his siblings, Wendy "Missy" Potter (Douglas) Vespie and Walter (Lorie) Potter; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, Claude Luther "C.L." Potter and Nancy Justes Potter, Sheriff Potter was preceded in death by his brother, William Michael "Porky" Potter; and

WHEREAS, Sheriff Potter leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Sheriff Wayne M. Potter, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Sheriff Potter.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.